Proposal: Startup & Talent ERP Platform

1. Executive summary

We propose a single ERP-style platform where startups, mentors, investors, job seekers, and employers manage their entire journey in one account: a startup registers its team, moves through four growth stages, gets mentored until it's investment-ready, and pitches investors directly, while the same platform hires talent and trains candidates with AI.

The platform has seven modules:

1. **Startup workspace** with team registration and four stage-based toolkits.
2. **Mentor hub** to make startups investment-ready.
3. **Investor connect** for direct startup-to-investor deal flow.
4. **Jobs marketplace** linking job seekers with startups and companies.
5. **AI interview trainer** for mock interviews and feedback.
6. **AI resume maker** tailored to each job.
7. **ERP core and admin** for identity, billing, analytics, and compliance.

The proposal covers scope, architecture, business model, a phased roadmap, and risks. Figures for budget and timeline are planning estimates to be validated with you.

2. Problem and opportunity

Early-stage founders, their mentors and funders, and people who want to work for them all use disconnected tools, so each group struggles to find the others.

Group	Today's pain	What the platform changes
Startups	Team data, progress, and pitch material scattered across docs, chats, and sheets	One workspace with stage-based checklists and a readiness score
Mentors	Hard to find startups that fit their expertise; no way to track outcomes	Matched startups, structured sessions, visible impact
Investors	Noisy, unvetted deal flow	Pre-screened, mentor-vetted startups with standard data rooms
Job seekers	Generic applications, little interview practice	AI resume, AI interview training, direct access to hiring startups
Employers	Slow, expensive hiring; weak candidate prep	Ready candidates and a hiring pipeline inside the same system

The differentiator is the loop between sections: a startup that grows needs hires; those hires are trained on the same platform; the startup's readiness data helps investors; mentors improve that data.

3. Vision, objectives and user roles

Vision: be the single operating system for the startup ecosystem, from first idea to funded company and the team that builds it.

Objectives

- Give every registered startup a clear stage, a roadmap, and an investment-readiness score.
- Connect startups to mentors and investors without intermediaries.
- Shorten time-to-hire for startups and time-to-offer for job seekers.
- Make candidates job-ready with AI interview practice and AI-built resumes.

User roles

Role	Registers as	Main goal
Startup founder/team member	Startup with team	Build, get mentored, raise funds, hire
Mentor	Individual expert	Guide startups to investment readiness
Investor	Individual, angel group or fund	Discover and fund vetted startups
Job seeker	Individual	Get job-ready and get hired
Employer	Startup or company	Post jobs, hire candidates
Platform admin	Internal team	Verify, moderate, support, report

5. Startup module

A startup registers once with its legal details, pitch summary, and team (founders, members, roles, permissions). It then selects or is assigned one of four stages, and the workspace changes to match. Moving up a stage requires meeting exit criteria, reviewed by a mentor or admin.

Stage	Focus	Key tools in the workspace	Exit criteria to next stage
1. Idea	Validate the problem and market	Idea canvas, problem and customer interviews tracker, market sizing template, co-founder search	Validated problem, defined target customer
2. Prototype	Build and test an MVP	Roadmap and sprint board, prototype and feedback log, user-testing tracker, grant and incubator listings	Working MVP with first test users

Stage	Focus	Key tools in the workspace	Exit criteria to next stage
3. Early revenue	Prove traction	Customer and sales pipeline, revenue and burn dashboard, KPI tracker, hiring requests to the Jobs module	Recurring revenue and a repeatable sales motion
4. Mature	Scale and raise growth capital	Finance and cap table, HR and payroll basics, board and investor reporting, data room	Ongoing: growth, funding rounds, exits

Common to all stages

- Team directory, roles and access control.
- Task and milestone management.
- Document vault and shared notes.
- A readiness score (0 to 100) built from stage checklist completion, traction data and mentor feedback; it feeds the Mentor and Investor modules.
- Public startup profile, visible to mentors and investors only if the founders choose.

6. Mentor module

Mentors take startups from "has a business" to "ready to be funded". The module treats investment readiness as a checklist that mentors sign off on item by item.

How it works

1. A mentor applies with a profile, expertise, past exits or roles; admin verifies.
2. Startups browse or are auto-matched by industry, stage and need.
3. The mentor and startup agree a plan: goals, session cadence, deliverables.
4. Sessions are booked, held (video link and notes) and logged in the platform.
5. The mentor signs off readiness checklist items; when all pass, the startup earns an **Investment Ready** badge.

Investment-readiness checklist

- Pitch deck and one-page summary reviewed.
- Business model and unit economics validated.
- Financial projections and use of funds defined.
- Cap table and legal basics in order.
- Traction metrics documented.
- Data room complete.

Mentor incentives: paid sessions, equity or advisory share where agreed, a public impact record, and priority access to investor events.

7. Investor module

Investors see only startups that opted in, with the mentor-verified badge shown first. Startups and investors then talk directly inside the platform.

Feature	For investors	For startups
Verified registration	Angels, funds and groups with KYC checks	Confidence the investor is real
Deal discovery	Filter by stage, sector, location, ticket size, readiness score	Appear in relevant searches only
Startup profile and data room	Deck, financials, traction, team in one view	Share once, control access per investor
Direct messaging and meeting scheduler	Contact founders without intermediaries	Respond on their own terms
Interest tracking	Shortlist, notes, pipeline stages	See who viewed and who is interested
Term sheet and round tracking	Record offers and commitments	Manage the round and update the cap table

Safeguards: confidentiality agreements before data room access, audit trail of document views, and a clear disclaimer that the platform introduces parties but is not a broker or adviser unless licensed (see section 11).

8. Jobs module

Job seekers and employers meet in a two-sided marketplace. Employers can be startups from the platform (jobs post straight from their workspace) or outside companies.

Job seekers

- Profile built from the AI resume maker, with skills, experience and preferences.
- Search and filter by role, location, remote, salary, company stage.
- One-click apply, application tracker and status alerts.
- AI job recommendations and a job-readiness score from interview practice.

Employers

- Company or startup page and verified-employer badge.
- Job posting with screening questions.
- Applicant pipeline (applied, shortlisted, interview, offer, hired).
- Candidate search and shortlist, with practice scores visible if the candidate allows.
- Startups can attach a "hiring request" from their stage plan, for example engineers needed at the prototype stage.

Trust and quality: employer verification, spam and fake-posting reports, and candidate consent for any shared data.

9. AI interview training

Candidates practise realistic interviews and get specific feedback, so they arrive job-ready.

Capability	What the candidate gets
Role-based mock interviews	Question sets by role, level and industry, plus a mode built from a real job posting
Voice and video practice	AI interviewer asks questions and follows up on answers
Answer feedback	Scores on clarity, structure, relevance and confidence, with suggested better answers
Delivery analysis	Pace, filler words, eye contact and tone (opt-in)
Interview types	HR, behavioural (STAR), technical, case, and startup founder-fit
Progress tracking	Session history, score trend, weak-area drills, readiness score shared with the Jobs module

Design notes: recordings are private by default and deletable on request; scoring rubrics are published so candidates know how they are judged; the AI is a practice tool and never a hiring decision-maker.

10. AI resume maker

The resume maker turns a short guided conversation or an uploaded old resume into a clean, job-specific resume in minutes.

1. **Input:** answer prompts, import an existing resume, or link a profile.
2. **AI drafting:** converts duties into achievement-style bullets and suggests missing skills.
3. **Job tailoring:** paste or pick a job from the Jobs module; the AI rewrites keywords and ordering to fit it.
4. **ATS check:** scores readability for applicant-tracking systems and flags issues.
5. **Templates and export:** several layouts, export to PDF and Word, one-click apply.
6. **Versions:** keep a resume per target role, all linked to the candidate profile.

The AI only reshapes facts the candidate provides; it flags any claim it cannot support and never invents experience.

11. ERP core, admin, security and compliance

The ERP core is the shared layer every module relies on, so a person or startup has one identity, one billing relationship and one data model.

- **Identity and access:** single sign-on, multi-role accounts (a founder can also be a mentor), team roles and permissions.
- **Verification:** KYC for investors, business checks for startups and employers, credential checks for mentors.
- **Billing:** subscriptions, per-session mentor payments, job-posting fees, invoices and payouts.
- **Notifications and messaging:** email, in-app and mobile push; secure direct chat.
- **Analytics:** stage progress, funnel from registration to funding or hire, revenue, usage.
- **Admin console:** approvals, moderation, dispute handling, content and template management, audit logs.

Security and compliance

- Encryption in transit and at rest, role-based access, full audit trail.
- Consent-based sharing of personal and company data.
- Compliance with applicable data-protection law (for example India's DPDP Act, and GDPR if serving EU users).
- Securities and investment rules: confirm with counsel whether the investor module needs registration; the platform should be positioned as an introduction service unless licensed.

12. Technology stack and AI approach

The stack below is a recommended starting point, chosen for speed to market and a small team; it can change after discovery.

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Web app	React or Next.js	Fast UI, strong ecosystem
Mobile	React Native or responsive web first	Reuse code; mobile after launch
Backend	Modular monolith (Node.js or Python), split into services as load grows	Simpler to build and run early
Database	PostgreSQL, plus object storage for files and recordings	Relational data fits ERP workflows
Search and matching	OpenSearch or Postgres full-text, plus embeddings	Mentor, investor and job matching
AI	Hosted large language model API for resume, feedback and interviewer; speech-to-text for voice	Avoids training models from scratch
Video	Managed video API (WebRTC)	Mentor sessions and interview practice
Cloud	One major cloud provider with managed services	Lower operations burden

AI guardrails: human review for any scoring that affects people, published rubrics, bias testing on resume and interview feedback, no use of candidate data to train third-party models, and clear AI labels throughout.

13. Business model and revenue streams

Revenue comes from several sides of the marketplace, with a free entry tier so each group can join. Prices are to be set after market research.

Stream	Paid by	Model
Startup subscription	Startups	Free basic workspace; paid tiers for advanced stage tools, data room and analytics
Mentor session fee	Startups	Commission on paid mentor sessions
Investor membership	Investors	Subscription for deal-flow access and tools
Success fee	Startups or investors	Optional fee on rounds closed through the platform (subject to legal review)
Job postings	Employers	Per-post fee or subscription; featured listings
Candidate premium	Job seekers	Free basics; paid AI interview packs and premium resume features
Partnerships	Banks, incubators, colleges	Sponsored programmes and white-label access

15. Risks, success metrics and next steps

Key risks

Risk	Mitigation
Chicken-and-egg: no investors without startups, no startups without investors	Launch with startups and mentors first; recruit a small set of anchor investors and employers early
Regulation on investment introductions	Early legal review; position as an introduction platform; add licensed partners if needed
AI quality or bias in interviews and resumes	Published rubrics, bias testing, human review, easy feedback and correction
Low-quality startups or fake profiles	Verification, mentor sign-off, ratings and reporting
Data privacy and security	Security by design, consent, regular audits
Scope too large for one release	Phased roadmap with a focused first release

Success metrics

- Registered startups, share reaching each stage, and share earning the Investment Ready badge.
- Mentor sessions held and mentor-to-startup match rate.
- Investor introductions and rounds closed.
- Jobs posted, applications per job, and time-to-hire.
- Interview sessions completed and resumes generated per active candidate.
- Monthly recurring revenue and retention by user group.